

Lesson 2: Meet Scratch and Your First Sprite

Hi again, coder! 🖐️

Remember when you gave clear step-by-step instructions with no computer at all? Today you get to do that for real, inside a coding tool called **Scratch**!

Think Like a Coder: What's in Scratch?

When you open Scratch, you'll see four important areas: - **The Stage** — like a little TV screen where your story or game happens. - **The Sprite List** — shows all the characters in your project. - **The Block Palette** — colorful blocks, each one an instruction, sorted by color and type. - **The Code Area** — the empty space where you snap blocks together.

Robot Tip

Every Scratch block is one clear instruction — just like when you told your partner "take 3 steps forward" in the Human Robot game! When you snap blocks together, you're building a stack of instructions your sprite will follow, one after another.

Your First Steps

1. Open Scratch and look at the Cat sprite (it's already there for you).
2. Find the **Motion** blocks (they're blue). Drag a **"move 10 steps"** block into the code area.
3. Click directly on the block. Watch — the cat moves!
4. Find the **Looks** blocks (purple). Drag a **"say Hello for 2 seconds"** block and snap it UNDER your move block.
5. Click the whole stack. Your cat moves AND says hello!

Make It Yours: Add a New Sprite

1. Click the little sprite button near the bottom right (it looks like a cat face with a plus sign).
2. Pick any sprite you like from the library — an animal, food, a fantasy creature, anything!

3. Give your new sprite a fun name.
4. Add a "move" block and a "say" block that introduces your sprite, like: "Hi, I'm Sparkle the Unicorn!"
5. Click the green flag at the top of the stage to run your whole project.

Bonus Challenge

Can you make your sprite move, say something, change its costume, AND make a sound — all in one stack of blocks? Try adding a "next costume" block and a sound block to your stack!

Debug Detective

Uh-oh! Someone's cat sprite has a "move 10 steps" block in the code area, but nothing happens when they click it. What could be wrong? - Did they click directly ON the block? - Is the Cat sprite actually selected in the sprite list? - Is the sprite maybe off the edge of the stage where you can't see it move?

Try checking these clues like a real debug detective!

Victory Moment

You just brought a character to life with real code! Next time, we'll learn even more ways to make your sprites move, look different, and make sounds. See you in Lesson 3! 